

GAME THEORY

FOR COLLEGE
APPLICATIONS

SELECTION OF SCHOOLS

- While undoubtedly in you are the creme de la creme of your country's academic rankings, you will most certainly be drawn towards top US and global institutions as your favorite choices to apply to.
- However, you should also note that seeking reputable institutions has never been a crime. If you are strategic applicants as I guess you are, a blend of reach, match and safety schools always makes a good college list.
- There are colleges that have the programs you seek for your undergraduate studies and still offer full financial aid to international students. Do **NOT** be biased against them because they are not renowned.

WHY REPUTABLE INSTITUTIONS?

- Greater alumni network to tap into after graduations
- Multiple opportunities e.g. internships, summer programs, research
- Higher starting salaries
- Surplus funding

APPLYING TO REPUTABLE INSTITUTIONS

- Essays must be most compelling and authentic they can be
- Recommendation letters must give clear and unique pictures of who you are as an applicant in the classroom and outside the classroom
- Outstanding academics
- Higher test scores(1450 and above)

WHAT IF I CHOOSE A NOT-SO REPUTABLE INSTITUTION?

- You might still enjoy the benefits of studying the program you are passionate about and getting full rides.
- However, when it comes to the job market, you will have to be aim to stand out amongst peers who went to reputable institutions.
- Opportunities too, within the school, may be limited.

APPLYING TO MATCH AND SAFETY SCHOOLS

- Essays must be most compelling and authentic they can be
- Recommendation letters must give clear and unique pictures of who you are as an applicant in the classroom and outside the classroom
- Outstanding academics
- Higher test scores(1400 and above)

SELECTION OF COURSES

- Coming from the most under-developed continents in the world, you might have missed multiple significant opportunities to stimulate your intellectual curiosity e.g. shortage of internships, shortage of academic and extracurricular activities etc....
- Applicants from other continents, have by far multiple opportunities and have engaged in significant activities that prepare them for college e.g. summer programs, internships, research, olympiads, hackathons etc..
- They are therefore more suited to be accepted into courses they seek especially in Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics.

- By nature, some courses in some schools are highly competitive and one would have to stand out to be accepted. E.g. computer science at Stanford.
- Game theory therefore calls that when such a scenario rises up, choose a less competitive course such as biomedical engineering, environmental engineering political science or economics and tailor your applications to suit such majors of interest.

Tuyaako Kristoff

- Internship at Uber
- Gold Medallist Uber Global Hackathon 2018
- DevPost Bronze Medallist Moscow 2019
- IT Captain St. Mary's High School

WHAT IF I PICK A HIGHLY SELECTIVE COURSE

- You will have to demonstrate how you have engaged with course-related course and how they stimulate your intellectual curiosity
- You will have to show passion about the course in your why major essays

KNOWING THE ANSWER

- What kind of student does said school look for?
- What do they look for in the applications?

- Sometimes, knowing the answer to what an institution seeks can be a great way to tailor your application to meet the demands of that institutions.
- How is this done? Looking at sample acceptance letters, researching on a school's motto, mission, vision, presidential statements.

- E.g. an applicant considering MIT or Caltech or Harvey Mudd, must demonstrate sufficient Science and Technology college spark.
- An applicant considering Yale can take note of its top-notch liberal arts programs and tailor his application to that.
- An applicant considering NYU-AD campus, can take note of how diversity is embedded in the NYU philosophy and demonstrate how he or she is a diverse applicant and can thrive in diverse settings.
- An applicant to Stanford should know Stanford likes intellectual vitality/curiosity and make his or her application meet that.

EARLY ROUND APPLICATIONS VS REGULAR ROUND APPLICATIONS

Yale Class of 2027

2275

Early Round - **500** applicants- **2275** spots- **300** accepted

- A smaller number of students, applying for an infinite number of spots.

Regular Round- **12000** applicants- **1975** spots- **1975** accepted

- A larger pool of applicants, applying for a finite number of spots

WHAT DOES THIS DATA TELL US?

- Applying in the early round, means you have a greater chance of getting in, due to the limitless class size and smaller number of applicants.
- So when you choose an early round school, go **ALL IN!**
- **Your early application should be the most compelling application you will submit.**
- From mid- September, your entire focus should be on the school you have chosen for the early round.